unit 1

ا

alif

ـا

'a' in father when long

unit 1



ب

be

ب بـ ـبـ

'b' in bat

unit 1



ک

kāf

ک کـ ـک

'k' in kite

unit 1



ل

lām

ل لـ ـل

'l' in log

unit 1



م

mīm

م مـ ـمـ

'm' in mat

unit 1



ن

nūn

ن نـ ـنـ

'n' in net

unit 2

3

ت

te

ت تـ ـتـ

soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth (Spanish 'tú')

unit 2



ی

choṭī ye

ی یـ ـیـ

'y' in yes at the start

unit 2

ے

baṛī ye

ے

'ay' in day

unit 3



پ

pe

پ پـ ـپـ

'p' in pat

unit 3



ٹ

ṭe

ٹ ٹـ ـٹـ

hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back

unit 3



ث

s̱e

ث ثـ ـثـ

's' in sun (Arabic loanwords only)

unit 4



و

wāʾo

و

'w'/'v' at the start

unit 4



ر

re

ر

tapped 'r' (Spanish 'pero')

unit 4



د

dāl

د

soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth

unit 4



ہ

choṭī he (gol he)

ہ ہہ ہ

'h' in hat

unit 5



س

sīn

س سس سس

's' in sun

unit 5



ش

shīn

ش شش شش

'sh' in shop

unit 5



ج

jīm

ج جج ج

'j' in jam

unit 5



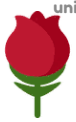
چ

che

چ چچ چ

'ch' in chair

unit 5



گ

gāf

گ گگ گ

'g' in go

unit 6

ں

nūn ghunna

ں

nasalises the vowel before it, like French 'bon'

unit 6



ھ

do-chashmī he

ھ ھھ ھ

a puff of breath after the letter before it: بھ bh, پھ ph, کھ kh, گھ gh...

unit 7



ڈ ط

ḍāl

ڈ

hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back

unit 7



ڑ

ṛe

ـڑ

a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)

unit 7



ز

ze

ـز

'z' in zoo

unit 7



ژ

zhe

ـژ

's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)

unit 8



ف

fe

ـف ـفـ فـ

'f' in fat

unit 8



ق

qāf

ـق ـقـ قـ

a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 8



خ

k̲he

ـخ ـخـ خـ

'ch' in Scottish loch

unit 8



غ

g̲hain

ـغ ـغـ غـ

a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'

unit 8



ع

ʻain

ـع ـعـ عـ

in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel written around it (عمر umar)

unit 8

ح

baṛī ḥe

ـح ـحـ حـ

'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 9



ص

ṣwād

ـص ـصـ صـ

's' in sun

unit 9



ض

ẓwād

ـض ـضـ ضـ

'z' in zoo

unit 9



ط

ṭo'e

ـط ـطـ طـ

soft 't'

unit 9

ظ

ẓo'e

ظ ظـ ظـ

'z' in zoo

unit 9



ذ

ẕāl

ذ

'z' in zoo

unit 10

ىٔ

hamza

ىٔ ـئـ ـئ

a tiny break between two vowels (کوئی ko-ī). It rides on ی as ئ, on و as ؤ, or stands alone…